



The makers of this device want to ensure that its users enjoy the best ever experience with a Linux laptop and they have left no stone unturned to achieve their goal. This means users will find Librem 15 a top-quality laptop that resembles MacBook Pro a lot, and comes with Libre software. Since people

within the Free Software Foundation believe that the kernel, the drivers as well as the applications should also be free and open source, Nouveau drivers have been used since the official NVIDIA drivers are not free.

Developers of Librem 15 have posted the following, "First of all, we would like to thank each and every backer who has helped us exceed our goal, with days still remaining! This means the Librem 15 will be going to production, and you will receive your laptop as soon as we get the motherboard fabricated and the laptop assembled! Your comments, questions, support, criticism and advice have led us to create something that we all are very proud of."

Mini-DebConf Mumbai 2015 meets with a good response

The Mini-DebConf Mumbai 2015 was held at IIT Bombay on January 17 and 18, 2015. It was organised by four youngsters—Rigved Rakshit, Purvash Ramesh Shah, Augustine Correa and Siji Sunny—from Debian India. The event was inaugurated by Prof. Kumar Appiah from the Department of Electrical Engineering, IIT Bombay. This was followed by the first keynote session by Venkatesh Hariharan, who has worked at Google and Red Hat in the past. The keynote session on Day 2 was by Prof. Kannan Moudgalya from the Department of Chemical Engineering, IIT Bombay, who is also the head of the Free and Open Source Software for Education (FOSSE) project.

The Mini-DebConf had sessions on open source security with Kali Linux by Rizwan Shaikh, a security researcher and cyber crime consultant, who gave a live demo of password cracking using the Hydra tool from Kali Linux. He hacked into the Android smartphones of a few participants using tools available in Kali Linux and explained how hackers install Trojans to control a smartphone remotely in order to steal sensitive information. The event also included talks on open hardware, Arduino Tre and BeagleBone Black. Other major attractions were the sessions, 'Li'Debi: Running Debian on Android' by Kumar Sukhani, an open source enthusiast at Cloudwalk and 'Debian on ARM' by Siji Sunny.

The first ever Mini-DebConf at Mumbai concluded with a good response and the organisers are targeting an even bigger event next year!

Microsoft Office now available on Android tablets for free

Taking yet another step towards 'openness', Microsoft has made its office suite available on Android tablets for free. This means that Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint applications can now be accessed on Android tablets at no cost.

The company has also released the Outlook email program for iPhones and iPads,



Is Bill Gates in favour of Ubuntu Linux?

Believe it or not, Bill Gates is promoting Ubuntu Linux! The Internet was abuzz when Gates published an image on his Facebook page along with a link to his website with a message, "15 years from now, most people in poor countries will be able to take classes online." This goal sounds good and is achievable too. But what grabbed eyeballs is that the operating system shown on the image is Ubuntu.



Well, the message deserves more attention no doubt, especially when it comes from someone like Gates, the former Microsoft CEO and founder of Windows. But what we sincerely wonder is whether this particular detail was just a mistake or has it been posted intentionally? After resigning from his position as CEO at Microsoft, Gates has dedicated his life to charity work, and has established a foundation to support several important projects like the global elimination of polio, malaria and some other diseases that ravage populations in poor countries.

It's difficult to imagine the Windows OS being used in such poor regions, where people are struggling to buy basic necessities like daily food, shelter and clothes. In that case, Ubuntu is a better choice as it's available for free and can run on older computers too. Hence, we could conclude that the image has not been chosen randomly and that Bill Gates has intentionally promoted Ubuntu on his Facebook page.